EMMANUEL THABO SAKONTA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional who has completed the Microsoft SC-200 Security Operations Analyst course through NEMISA (2026) and is preparing for the SC-200 certification exam. Has developed a practical cybersecurity portfolio focused on Security Operations, Microsoft Sentinel, Detection Engineering, Threat Hunting, Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR), Windows Security Analysis and SOC Automation.

Demonstrates hands-on practical experience in developing security detection logic, analysing security events, investigating simulated alerts, conducting threat hunts, mapping adversary behaviour to the MITRE ATT&CK Framework, documenting investigation findings and developing security automation using Python and Bash.

Brings more than a decade of South African public-sector experience in investigations, compliance, risk-related administration, confidential information management, evidence-based documentation, records management and stakeholder coordination. Also brings electoral operations experience as a Deputy Presiding Officer (DPO) with the Independent Electoral Commission (IEC).

Target Roles: SOC Analyst | Junior SOC Analyst | Cybersecurity Analyst | Security Operations Analyst | Junior Security Analyst

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Security Operations:** Alert monitoring, alert triage, incident investigation, event correlation, incident documentation and escalation.
- **Detection & Threat Hunting:** Detection engineering, Sigma, KQL, threat hunting, IOC investigation, Windows Event Analysis and MITRE ATT&CK.
- **Microsoft Security:** Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender concepts, security operations and SIEM investigation.
- **DFIR & Endpoint Security:** Digital forensics and incident response, endpoint investigation, evidence collection, Velociraptor concepts and Windows Security Analysis.
- **Automation & Systems:** Python, Bash, Linux, Windows, PowerShell, Git and GitHub.
- **Network Security:** Wireshark, network traffic analysis, DNS, HTTP, TCP/IP and suspicious network activity.
- **Governance & Compliance:** Risk identification, compliance monitoring, POPIA awareness, NIST awareness and ISO 27001 awareness.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **Microsoft SC-200 Security Operations Analyst Course:** NEMISA, completed 2026; preparing for the SC-200 certification exam.
- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate:** Coursera, 2025.
- **Career Essentials in Cybersecurity:** NEMISA, 2025.
- **Cybersecurity Foundations:** LinkedIn Learning, 2025.
- **Career Essentials in Generative AI:** NEMISA, 2025.
- **Microsoft 101 & Digital Literacy:** NEMISA, 2025.
- **Introduction to Artificial Intelligence:** LinkedIn Learning, 2025.

CYBERSECURITY PORTFOLIO

- **Microsoft Sentinel Detection Engineering Lab:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, detection engineering, threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK and SOAR. Developed detections for suspicious PowerShell, failed authentication and process-creation activity; applied KQL investigation; mapped findings to ATT&CK; designed a SOAR host-isolation playbook; and documented investigations. Repository: Microsoft-Sentinel-Detection-Engineering-Lab.
- **Velociraptor Investigation Lab:** DFIR, endpoint investigation, threat hunting and evidence analysis. Investigated process, network, file and endpoint artefacts in simulated scenarios and documented findings in investigation reports and ATT&CK mappings. Repository: velociraptor-investigation-lab.
- **Threat Hunting Lab:** Bash, Linux and log analysis. Built workflows for failed authentication, brute-force behaviour, suspicious IP activity, privilege escalation and persistence. Repository: threat-hunting-lab.
- **Detection Engineering Lab:** Sigma and Windows Security Events. Developed detection rules for authentication failures, privilege escalation, account creation and PowerShell execution, with ATT&CK mappings. Repository: detection-engineering-lab.
- **Python SOC Automation Lab:** Python and Windows Event Logs. Developed log parsing, event correlation and security alert analysis workflows to demonstrate support for SOC triage. Repository: Python-SOC-Automation-Lab.
- **Additional Security Projects:** Network Traffic Analysis (Wireshark, DNS, HTTP and suspicious traffic); SOC Mini SIEM (Linux log monitoring, file integrity monitoring and event correlation); Windows Security Analysis (authentication, account creation, privilege escalation and PowerShell).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Independent Cybersecurity Portfolio Developer | Self-directed | City of Johannesburg, Gauteng | November 2024 – Present**
- Designed and maintained a practical portfolio focused on SOC operations, detection engineering, threat hunting, DFIR, Microsoft Sentinel and security automation. Developed detection rules, hunting queries, investigation workflows and analyst-style reports; applied MITRE ATT&CK; used Git/GitHub for version control; and developed Python/Bash automation for log analysis and event correlation.
- **Independent Electoral Commission of South Africa (IEC) | Temporary Electoral Official – Deputy Presiding Officer | Kagiso Central, Mogale City, Gauteng | Various electoral appointments, 2024–2026**
- Served in Deputy Presiding Officer assignments for the 2024 National and Provincial Elections, the Mogale City Ward 12 municipal by-election (September 2024), and Local Government Elections (2026). Supported the Presiding Officer and voting-station operations; assisted with voter verification, ballot administration, electoral documentation and reconciliation; followed IEC procedures and operational controls; liaised with stakeholders; and maintained confidentiality, impartiality and accurate records. Participated in relevant IEC training, assessments and election-readiness activities.
- **Department of Employment and Labour | Senior Personnel Officer – Human Resource Management | October 2009 – June 2021**
- Supported workplace investigations, employee-service processes and administrative reviews requiring confidentiality and evidence-based documentation. Managed employee records, service conditions, benefits and leave processes using SAP/ESS and Persal. Coordinated recruitment and selection administration; monitored compliance with applicable legislation and public-service policies; compiled HR reports; served as secretary for Interview Panels, Employment Equity and Risk Committees; and coordinated with internal stakeholders.

EDUCATION

- **N Diploma: Business Management (In Progress – RPL):** N4, N5 and N6 National Certificates completed. Western TVET College / South West Gauteng TVET College | 2017–2020.
- **Result-Based Project Management: Monitoring & Evaluation (NQF Level 5):** University of the Witwatersrand | 2016.
- **Gender Mainstreaming Projects & Programmes (NQF Level 5):** PALAMA | 2009.

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- SAP HCM & SuccessFactors; Project Management Foundations; Risk Management & Fraud Prevention; Communication & Leadership Development.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Valid South African Code C1 driver's licence. References available on request.